E2 Reading – Personal Hygiene at Work – A Problem at Work

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 1 – Read the story

Tom works in a small shop. He is friendly and hardworking. But Tom has a problem – he doesn't wash very often. His clothes smell, and his breath is not fresh. Tom also smokes, and his clothes smell of tobacco.

One day, Tom's manager, Sara, decides to talk to him. She is kind but honest. She tells Tom that he needs to shower every day, wash his clothes more often and use deodorant. She also tells him to brush his teeth twice a day.

Tom is a little embarrassed, but he says thank you. The next week, he comes to work clean and fresh. His co-workers are happy, and Tom feels more confident too.

1. Where does Tom work? _____
2. What is Tom's problem? _____
3. Who talks to Tom about it? _____
4. What does Sara tell Tom to do? Write two things.
   _____
5. How does Tom feel at first? _____
6. How does Tom feel at the end? _____

Task 2 – Put the conversation in order

Number the lines 1–8. Number 1 has been done for you.

_____ **Tom:** I understand. I'm sorry. I'll shower every morning.
_____ **Sara:** You need to shower every day and wash your clothes more often.
_____ **Tom:** Thank you, Sara. I will.
__1__ **Sara:** Can I talk to you for a minute, Tom?
_____ **Sara:** I need to tell you something important. It's about personal hygiene.
_____ **Tom:** Oh… OK. What's the problem?
_____ **Sara:** Don't worry. Just try to remember from now on.
_____ **Tom:** Of course, Sara. Is everything OK?

Task 3 – Match the problem to the solution

Problem		Solution
1. Bad breath	___	A. Wash your clothes after one or two wears
2. Dirty hands	___	B. Use deodorant every day
3. Smelly armpits	___	C. Have a quick wash in the break
4. No shower this morning	___	D. Brush your teeth twice a day
5. Smelly clothes	___	E. Change your underwear every day
6. Clothes smell of tobacco	___	F. Wash your hands
7. Dirty underwear	___	G. Wash your clothes more often if you smoke

Task 4 – Match the product to its use

Product		Use
1. Toothpaste	___	A. for washing your hair
2. Deodorant	___	B. for cutting your nails
3. Soap	___	C. for washing your clothes
4. Shampoo	___	D. for cleaning your teeth
5. Washing powder	___	E. for stopping smelly armpits
6. Nail clippers	___	F. for washing your hands and body

Task 5 – Talk with a partner

Is it easy to tell someone about a problem like Tom's? How would you say it politely? Write one polite sentence.

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